即用即丢

题目汇总：

We have entered a throw – away society and fill the environment with rubbish. What are the causes and what are your solutions?

Nowadays, people like to throw away damaged things and buy new ones while people in the past would always reuse them by repair. Why do you think it is the case? What problems might this lead to?

Nowadays people prefer throwing the broken things away and buying new ones, but people used to repair broken things in the past. Why is that and give your opinion?

必备词汇

中文	英文
消费	Consume v. – consumption n.
消费者	Consumer
消费主义	Consumerism
过度消费	Overconsumption
经济发展	Economic growth
科技发展	Technological advance \ progress
文化发展	Cultural prosperity \ diversity
社会发展	Social development
耐用品	Durable goods
非耐用品	Non – durable goods
包装盒	Containers \ packaging
城市的固体垃圾	Municipal solid waste
构成	Represent \ constitute
大生产	Increased production \ mass production
商业模型	Business model
一次性餐具	Disposable food and drink containers
餐具	Tableware
有利可图	Economically advantageous
在…方面的劳工成本	Labor expense incurred in xxxx
贯彻法律	Enact the law
一次性筷子	Single – use chopsticks
出口	Export
桦树	Birch
云杉	Spruce
竹子	Bamboo
反复使用的筷子	Reusable chopsticks
筷子的寿命	Have a lifespan of 130 meals
收支平衡	Breakeven cost

垃圾	Garbage \trash \ rubbish \ waste \ liter
有毒的垃圾	Toxic waste
毒素	Toxin
电子垃圾	Electronic waste
有害垃圾	Hazardous waste
污染土壤	Contaminate soil
垃圾场	Landfill
有计划的报废	Planned obsolescence
生产哲学	Manufacturing philosophy
财务赤字	Debt – ridden
浪费的	Wasteful
永恒不满意的	Permanently discontented
公司	Firm\ company \ corporation
最大化利润	Maximize the profits
复购	Repeatedly purchase\ continue to repurchase
稳定的供应	A steady supply of customers
时装	Stylish clothes \ fashion clothes
表面的	Ostensibly \ superficial
卫生	Hygiene
方便	Convenience
更多的资源被使用	More resources are used
质量更差	Lesser quality goods
商品	Commodity\ goods\ products

外刊：

Rise of packaging waste

As a consequence of economic growth, we have seen both increased production and increased product waste during the last century. Between the start of New York City waste collections in 1905 and 2005 there was a tenfold rise in "product waste" (packaging and old products), from 92 to 1,242 pounds (42 to 563 kilograms) per person per year. Containers and packaging now represent 32 percent of all municipal solid waste. Non-durable goods (defined as products in use for less than three years) constitute 27 percent, while durable goods comprise 16 percent.

In order for the business model to work, fast food chains found it economically advantageous to convince consumers through advertising campaigns to carry their own tableware to a waste bins, in order to avoid labor expenses incurred in clearing tables.

In Germany, Austria, and Switzerland, laws banning use of disposable food and drink containers at large-scale events have been enacted.This includes events of all sizes, including very large ones (Christmas market, Auer-Dult Faire, Oktoberfest and Munich City Marathon). For small events of a few hundred people, the city has arranged for a corporation offer rental of crockery and dishwasher equipment. In part through this regulation, Munich reduced the waste generated by Oktoberfest, which attracts tens of thousands of people, from 11,000 metric tons in 1990 to 550 tons in 1999.

China produces about 57 billion pairs of single-use chopsticks yearly, of which half are exported. About 45 percent are made from trees – about 3.8 million of them – mainly

cotton wood, birch, and spruce, the remainder being made from bamboo. Japan uses about 24 billion pairs of these disposables per year, and globally about 80 billion pairs are thrown away by about 1.4 million people. Reusable chopsticks in restaurants have a lifespan of 130 meals. In Japan, with disposable ones costing about 2 cents and reusable ones costing typically $1.17, the reusables better the $2.60 breakeven cost. Campaigns in several countries to reduce this waste are beginning to have some effect.

Garbage produced because of the rise in disposable products is often shipped from richer to poorer nations, causing environmental and social problems for developing nations. Most notable are the large shipments of trash from North America and Western Europe to Africa and Asia due to the relatively low cost of disposal. By the 1990s, over half of all nations in Africa have faced negative externalities from toxic waste dumped by richer countries. Waste, both toxic and non-toxic is often dumped without safety regulations. It is thrown in unlined and unregulated landfills where it contaminates soil and water, and even burnt, which circulates toxins in the air. Recently, electronic waste shipped to Nigeria has increased due to higher consumption of electronics by North America Europe, with hundreds of shipments of old electronics dropped off at Lagos, Nigeria, every month. A significantly large percentage of the trash being hazardous waste shipped with the "explicit intent of cheap (and unsafe) disposal". China, also, receives huge amounts of waste, often toxic material, averaging 1.9 million tons per year, because companies find it cheaper to ship garbage away rather than dispose of it themselves. [11]

"Planned obsolescence" is a manufacturing philosophy developed in the 1920s and 1930s, when mass production became popular. The goal is to make a product or part that will fail, or become less desirable over time or after a certain amount of use. Vance Packard, author of *The Waste Makers*, book published in 1960, called this "the systematic attempt of business to make us wasteful, debt-ridden, permanently discontented individuals."

Producers make goods disposable rather than durable so that consumers must continue to repurchase the good, earning the producer a steady supply of customers, rather than a one-time purchase. Profit is maximized for the firm when the usefulness of a good is "uneconomically short", because firms can spend the least amount possible creating a nondurable good, which they sell repeatedly to the customer.
stylish clothes to keep up with current fashion trends. Items that once were considered durable items are now almost exclusively disposable, so it is actually more difficult for consumers who want a durable version to find anywhere selling one. The shift to disposable was ostensibly because of reasons such as convenience or hygiene, even if the inconvenience of using a durable version is very slight, or there is no proven increase in hygiene. This can lead to higher costs over time, more waste produced, more resources used, and lesser quality goods.

Main idea (外刊)
Reason 1--- Economic growth – mass production – increased products and product waste – e.g. package and containers
Reason 2-- Fast food chains – business model – require customers to carry their table wares to the dustbin – avoid labor expense incurred in clearing table – financially advantageous\ profitable
Solution 1-- Many country –enact laws -- law banning use of disposable food and drink containers -- large scale-event: ban & Small event : rental of crockery and dishwasher equipment
Solution 2: Reusable chopsticks 1.17 130 meals V.S. single –used chopsticks 2 cent 2.6 --- low cost – reduce waste
Problem1: The disposable products are shipped from rich countries to poor nations – environmental and social problems –export – cheap landfill \ burn – unlined and unregulated – e.g.toxic waste\ hazardous rubbish \ electronic waste – contaminate soil and water \ circulate toxin into the air
Reason 3: Manufacturing philosophy --- Planned obsolescence ---mass production – make a product or part of it fail --- conception: less desirable ---problem 2: wasteful \ debt-ridden \ permanently discontent individuals
Reason 4: Make goods disposable rather than durable – producer: a steady supply --- repeatedly purchase\ continue to repurchase the goods – maximize the profits – motivation: non durable products
Reason 5: Stylish clothes – exclusively disposable – durable: inconvenience \ not hygiene – problem 3: higher cost \ more resourced used \ less quality goods\more waste

produced

整合逻辑链条：

Reasons:

In the past: suffering from the shortage of material supplies – cherished things they owned

Current: Economic growth – mass production -- increased production – be surrounded by a wide range of commodities – people's requirement for a better living standard: incentive to manufacture a variety of goods – increased product waste: container and packaging\ non durable goods (less than 3 years)

Business model – carry their tableware to a waste bin – economically advantageous: 1. Avoid labor expense incurred in clearing table. 2. Convenience \attract consumers – sanitation

e.g. 2: Single –use chopsticks

manufacturing philosophy: planned obsolescence – definition: the goal is to make a product or part that will fail, or become less desirable over time or after a certain amount of use. – mass production – waste ---- attempt of a business makes us wasteful, debt-ridden and permanently discontented individuals – e.g. electronic waste

producers make goods disposable rather than durable --- consumers continue to repurchase the goods \ sell repeatedly to customers – a steady supply of customers rather than one time purchase – maximize the profits – non – durable goods – waste

the preference \ taste of customers – stylish cloth should keep up with current fashion trends

in the past: durable items

now: exclusively disposable – non – durable clothes – convenience and hygiene

result: more resourced used - higher costs - more wasted product – lesser quality goods

lavish style – no awareness of reducing, reusing and recycling waste --- e.g. new models of mobile phones appear on the market – prone to buy the new ones rather than keeping the old ones – waste

Solution:

Laws banning in the use of disposable food and drink containers have been enacted

Certain corporation offer rental of crockery and dishwasher equipment

Reusable chopsticks: lifespan: 130 meals

Technology –develop more advanced waste recycling system – intractable trash - plastic\ non-recyclable packaging material

Tradition:

The lower cost of shipment compared with disposition by themselves \ lack of regulation

of waste disposition ---- developed countries export trash to poorer countries
Current：
Technology

Propagated\ advocated by mass media – e.g. We chat, Tiktok – raise the awareness ---1. the benefits of durable products \ the drawbacks of disposable products 2. Accurate lifestyle: lavish style – clothes – inconvenience is slight \ no proven hygiene 3. Electronic products – manufacturing philosophy – debt-ridden – deceive

文章二： 九分达人 第二册

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【阅读2】9分达人雅思阅读真题还原

READING PASSAGE 3

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 27-40** which are based on Reading Passage 3 below.*

Designed to Last: Could Better Design Cure Our Throwaway Culture?

Jonathan Chapman, a senior lecturer at the University of Brighton, UK, is one of a new breed of 'sustainable designers'. Like many of us, they are concerned about the huge waste associated with Western consumer culture and the damage this does to the environment. Some, like Chapman, aim to create objects we will want to keep rather than discard. Others are working to create more efficient or durable consumer goods, or goods designed with recycling in mind. The waste entailed in our fleeting relationships with consumer durables is colossal.

Domestic power tools, such as electric drills, are a typical example of such waste. However much DIY the purchaser plans to do, the truth is that these things are thrown away having been used, on average, for just ten minutes. Most will serve 'conscience time', gathering dust on a shelf in the garage; people are reluctant to admit that they have wasted their money. However, the end is inevitable: thousands of years in landfill waste sites. In its design, manufacture, packaging, transportation and disposal, a power tool consumes many times its own weight of resources, all for a shorter active lifespan than that of the average small insect.

To understand why we have become so wasteful, we should look to the underlying motivation of consumers. "People own things to give expression to who they are, and to show what group of people they feel they belong to," Chapman says. In a world of mass production, however, that symbolism has lost much of its potency. For most of human history, people had an intimate relationship with objects they used or treasured. Often they made the objects themselves, or family members passed them on. For more specialised objects, people relied on expert manufacturers living close by, whom they probably knew personally. Chapman points out that all these factors gave objects a history — a narrative — and an emotional connection that today's mass-produced goods cannot possibly match. Without these personal connections, consumerist culture idolizes novelty instead. People know that they cannot buy happiness, but the chance to remake themselves with glossy, box-fresh products seems irresistible. When the novelty fades, they simply renew the excitement by buying more.

Chapman's solution is what he calls 'emotionally durable design'. He says the challenge for designers is to create things we want to keep. This may sound like a tall

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【阅读2】9分达人雅思阅读真题还原

order, but it can be surprisingly straightforward. A favorite pair of old jeans, for example, just do not have the right feel until they have been worn and washed a hundred times. It is as if they are sharing the wearer's life story. The look can be faked, but it is simply not the same. Walter Stahel, visiting professor at the University of Surrey, UK, calls this 'the teddy bear factor'. No matter how ragged and worn a favorite teddy becomes, we don't rush out and buy another one. As adults, our teddy bear connects us to our childhood and this protects it from obsolescence. Stahel argues that this is what sustainable design needs to do with more products.

The information age was supposed to lighten our economies and reduce our impact on the environment, but, in fact, the reverse seems to be happening. We have simply added information technology to the industrial era and speeded up the developed world's metabolism. The cure is hardly rocket science: minimise waste, stop moving things around so much and use people more. So what will post-throwaway consumerism look like? It might be as simple as installing energy-saving light bulbs, more efficient washing machines or choosing locally produced groceries with less packaging. In general, we will spend less on goods and more on services. Instead of buying a second car, for example, we might buy into a car-sharing network. Rather than following our current wasteful practices, we will buy less and rent a lot more; why own things such as tools that you use infrequently, especially things are likely to be updated all the time?

Consumer durables will increasingly be sold with plans for their disposal. Electronic goods such as mobile phones will be designed to be recyclable, with the extra cost added into the retail price. Following Chapman's notion of emotionally durable design, there will be a move away from mass production and towards tailor-made articles and products designed and manufactured with greater craftsmanship, products which will be repaired rather than replaced, in the same way as was done in our grandparents' time. Companies will replace profit from bulk sales by servicing and repairing products chosen because we want them to last.

Chapman acknowledges that it will be a challenge to persuade people to buy fewer goods, and ones that they intend to keep. At the moment, price competition between retailers makes it cheaper for consumers to replace rather than repair.

Products designed to be durable and emotionally satisfying are likely to be more expensive, so how will we be persuaded to choose sustainability? Tim Cooper, from Sheffield Hallam University in the UK, points out that many people are already happy to pay a premium for quality, and that they also tend to value and care more for expensive goods. Chapman is also positive: "People are ready to keep things for longer," he says, "The problem is that a lot of industries don't know how to do that." Chapman believes that sustainable design is here to stay. "The days when large corporations were in a position to choose whether to jump on the sustainability bandwagon or not are coming to an end," he says. Whether this is also the beginning of the end of the throwaway society remains to be seen.

Homework: 读上面的文章概括其他的理由：

Reason 1: western consumer culture

Solution 1: create objects we will want to keep rather than discard \ create durable goods \ goods designed with recycling in minds

Reason 2: DIY -- domestic power tools e.g. Electrical drill – have been used for just ten minutes – gather dust on a shelf in the garage – throw away – a power tool consumes many times its own weight of resources (design\ manufacture \ packing \ transportation \ disposal) – a shorter active lifespan

Reason 3: underlying motivation

In the past: intimate relationship with objects they used or treasured – make the objects themselves- people relied on expert manufacturers living close by, whom they probably knew personally – family members passed them on – gave objects a history – an emotional connection

Nowadays – mass – produced goods – without these personal connections – consumerist culture idolizes novelty – people know that they cannot buy happiness, but the chance to remake themselves with glossy, box- fresh products seems irresistible – novelty fades – renew the excitement by buying more.

Reason 4: price competition between retailers makes it cheaper for consumers to replace rather than repair

Solution 1: create objects we will want to keep rather than discard \ create durable goods \ goods designed with recycling in minds

Solution 2: emotionally durable design – create things we want to keep – e.g. teddy bear – no matter how ragged and worn a favorite teddy becomes – we do not rush out and buy another one – teddy bear connects us to our childhood – this protects it from obsolescence – sustainable design needs

Solution 3: technology – sharing network – buy less and rent a lot more – e.g.1 instead of buying a second car – we might buy into a car – sharing network e.g. 2: instead of owning things such as tools that you use infrequently, especially things are likely to be updated all the time ---- rent

Solution 4: a simple way of life – installing energy – saving light bulbs \ more efficient washing machines \ choosing locally produced groceries with less packing – spend less on goods and more on services.

Solution 5– producers – electronic goods such as mobile phones will be designed to be recyclable, with the extra cost added into the retail price ----- move away from mass production and towards tailor – made 定制的 articles and products designed and

manufactured with greater craftsmanship ---- products will be repaired rather than replaced --- companies will replace profit from bulk sales by servicing and repairing products chosen --- want products to last --- 反驳：expensive – less affordable - cannot carry out ---- 再反驳： people are already happy to pay a premium for quality and that they also tend to value and care more for expensive goods. – keep things for longer – end of throw –away society

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